

Programme Handbook & Engagement Brief

Everything your team needs to run the Generation Bridge Foundation engagement

Client	Generation Bridge Foundation
Document reference	MOM-2026-HB-01
Issued	Monday 13 July 2026
Classification	Participant material
Version	2.0 July 2026

1. Welcome to the engagement

Your team has been retained as external strategy consultants by the Board of Generation Bridge Foundation (GBF), a Vietnamese non-profit working on youth unemployment. Over the next six weeks you will diagnose a genuine strategic problem, test your thinking against incomplete evidence, and present a recommendation to the Board.

This is a simulated but realistic engagement. There is no single correct answer. You will be assessed on the quality of your thinking, the honesty of your evidence, the discipline of your teamwork, and the clarity of your communication.

Everything you need is contained in this package. You must not use external research, the internet, or any information beyond the materials provided. Operational datasets are held by Workflow B only. Where evidence is incomplete, say so; managing ambiguity is part of the exercise.

2. The client at a glance

Item	Detail
Organisation	Generation Bridge Foundation (Cau Noi The He)
Founded	2014, Ho Chi Minh City
Mission	Connect 16-24 year-olds who are not in education, employment or training (NEET) to dignified work
2025 budget	VND 18.2 billion
Young people served in 2025	2,847
Current waitlist (Jan 2026)	approximately 2,400
Staff	67 full-time, 12 part-time, ~340 active volunteers
Delivery hubs	Ho Chi Minh City (2), Binh Duong (1), Dong Nai (1), Long An (pilot)

3. The question the Board has asked you

"What should GBF's strategy be for 2026 to 2028, and how should we allocate our limited resources to maximise dignified youth employment outcomes?"

- Engagement letter from the GBF Board, 15 January 2026

The Board is divided. Read the client data room carefully: senior staff, the largest donor and individual board members do not agree with one another. Some of what you are told will not survive contact with the operational record held by Workflow B.

4. How your team is organised: two workflows

Every team of five or six splits into two consulting workflows. The split is deliberate. Each workflow holds incomplete information. You must talk to each other to converge. Read both engagement briefs.

Workflow	Owns	Folder
A - Impact Strategy	Problem framing, stakeholder synthesis, the questions worth asking, strategic options, and the Board narrative	2_Workflow_A_Impact_Strategy

B - Operations & Analytics	The operational datasets, data dictionary, cleaning, analysis, and plain-language translation of findings	3_Workflow_B_Operations_and_Analytics
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The analysis request protocol

Workflow A does not receive the operational datasets and must not ask facilitators for the file. When A needs numbers, A files an Analysis Request. Workflow B answers with a Findings Memo in plain language, plus any charts B chooses to share. B must not hand over the raw workbook.

Before final options, the team must complete at least three Analysis Requests with Findings Memos returned. Every quantitative claim in A's deliverables must cite a Request ID or Findings Memo. The Cross-Workflow Handoff Checklist in the Shared Toolkit is the gate before submission.

5. What you will produce

Deliverable	Owner	Format	Due
Project Charter & RACI	Whole team	Word -> PDF; Excel	Tue 14 Jul
Problem statement & issue tree	Workflow A	Word -> PDF	Wed 15 Jul
Stakeholder map	Workflow A	Word -> PDF	Thu 16 Jul
Information credibility matrix	Whole team	Word -> PDF	Thu 16 Jul
Analysis Requests (min. 3 across Weeks 2-4)	Workflow A	Word -> PDF	Ongoing
Data quality report (internal to B)	Workflow B	Word -> PDF	Tue 21 Jul
Findings Memos (responses to requests)	Workflow B	Word -> PDF	Ongoing
Empathy & journey maps	Workflow A	Word -> PDF	Wed 22 Jul
Performance dashboard (B working file)	Workflow B	Excel	Fri 24 Jul
Strategic options (cite Request IDs)	Workflow A	Word -> PDF	Thu 30 Jul
Evidence-check memo	Workflow B	Word -> PDF	Fri 31 Jul
Trade-off reflection	Workflow A	Word -> PDF	Wed 5 Aug
Funding scenarios	Workflow B	Excel	Thu 6 Aug
Validation protocol & revision log	Whole team	Word -> PDF	Thu 6 Aug
Final report	Whole team	Word -> PDF	Fri 14 Aug
Board presentation	Whole team	PowerPoint	Thu 13 Aug
Peer evaluation	Individual	Word -> PDF	Mon 17 Aug
Reflection journal	Individual	Word -> PDF	Tue 18 Aug

The complete task-by-task timeline is in GBF_Consulting_Toolkit.xlsx, tab 'Master Timeline'. Track requests on the 'Request Log' tab.

6. Programme calendar

Week	Dates (2026)	Focus
1	13-17 July	Frame the problem; set up the request protocol
2	20-24 July	B cleans data; A files first requests; map beneficiary voices
3	27-31 July	Findings exchange; options drafted; evidence-check
4	3-7 August	Validate against interviews; model funding; revise
5	10-14 August	Finalise report and deck; present to the Board
6	17-21 August	Peer evaluation, reflection, debrief

7. How you will be assessed

A 100-point rubric applies. The weighting tells you where to invest effort.

Criterion	Points
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Problem understanding	15
Research quality	10
Design thinking	15
Data analysis and translation	20
Recommendations	20
Presentation	10
Project management	5
Teamwork and cross-workflow exchange	5

Strong teams ask precise questions, translate findings honestly, and own the costs of their preferred recommendation. Numbers without judgement, or judgement without numbers, both fall short.

8. Ground rules

1. Use only the materials in this package. Do not invent facts or seek outside data.
2. Workflow A must not open or request the raw operational datasets. Route all quantitative needs through Analysis Requests to Workflow B.
3. Workflow B must not share the raw workbook with Workflow A. Share Findings Memos and curated charts only.
4. Every claim must cite its source: a document (D-02), a transcript (ST-01), or a Request / Findings ID (R-03 / FM-03).
5. State the definitions you use, especially for the placement rate.
6. Deliverables are read as PDF, filled in as Word, analysed in Excel, and presented in PowerPoint.
7. Your Buddy is a facilitator, not a consultant. They will ask questions and offer graduated hints, but they will not give you the answer or the data file.

9. Package contents

Folder	What is inside
0_Start_Here	This handbook, the data room index, the deadline summary
1_Client_Data_Room	GBF documents (D-01 to D-12) and interview transcripts (no datasets)
2_Workflow_A_Impact_Strategy	Workflow A brief, playbook, A templates
3_Workflow_B_Operations_and_Analytics	Workflow B brief, data dictionary, datasets, dashboard, B templates
4_Shared_Toolkit	Toolkit workbook (incl. Request Log), guides, board deck, shared templates